

SECURITY WATCH

New Xbash malware a cocktail of features

Malware is seemingly growing into multi-faceted nuisances as is evidenced by Xbash, a malware named by the researchers at Palo Alto Networks.

While Linux servers are being targeted for ransomware and botnet capabilities, Windows servers at the same time are being targeted for ransomware and self propagation. Xbash has features that make it target and delete Linux based databases. The worst part is that it seems to contain no feature to be able to restore the data once deleted by the malware.

According to the researchers, so far people have paid a cumulative sum of \$6000 to the attackers, however, there's no confirmation of their data access being restored, if it has been done at all in any of the cases. It appears to be the efforts of Iron Group, a malicious actor also responsible for previous threats pertaining to ransomware and cryptocurrency.

MOBILE WATCH

Finney

While the Finney Smartphone from Sirin Labs isn't brand new, it's due in November and has a lot more details out as of now. The Finney is a \$999 worth smartphone that is designed for the blockchain. While the HTC Exodus is also a similar offering, not much is known about it.

While the Finney promises to support decentralised applications and also provide the most secure smartphone experience ever, it also imposes the restriction of Sirin Labs' own SRN being the default digital currency on the device. It runs on Sirin OS and packs a Snapdragon 845, along with 6 GB of RAM, 128 GB of expandable storage, a 12-megapixel rear camera and an 8-megapixel selfie camera. The phone has an 18:9 6-inch screen with significant bezels and a notch, powered by an average 3,280 mAh battery.



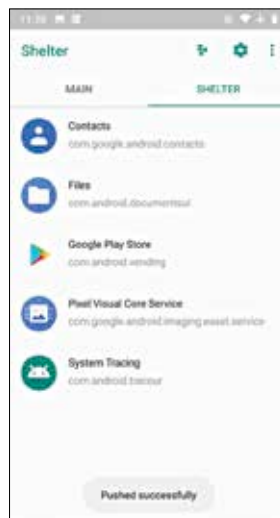
APP WATCH

Shelter

Before we say anything, please note that you need to install F-droid app store to install Shelter – which does not require root permissions. Once you've installed it, firing up the app will require you to give it "Work Profile" a.k.a admin permissions on your phone. Wait, hold on, what does this app actually do? Today, if you're on the web, you'd be naive to think that you're not being tracked by every single app or website you use. On your smartphone, Shelter is an app that

lets you run other apps in a sandbox before giving them your data so that you can take an informed decision about doing the same.

Once you've given it the requisite permissions, you will be able to see a list of main apps, tapping on which will allow you to create a sandboxed copy of the same. The best part? There's a sandboxed version of the Play Store as well. Installing anything from this Play Store downloads sandboxed versions of the apps themselves. Pretty



neat, right? This can also be useful if you want to use multiple accounts on a single app. Additionally, you can also freeze background heavy apps. Keep in mind that this isn't a total sandbox and won't keep you safe from security bugs on Android and backdoors. Also, if you have another app that manages the work profile on your device, Shelter will not work. However, we didn't face any of these issues on our Android device and the sandboxing experience was seamless.

Doctor Insta



While there are quite a few apps out there dedicated to healthcare, Doctor Insta is all about getting you a doctor consultation on your phone, via video or call, as soon as possible, in a seamless, effective manner.

Facemoji



This app isn't new, but its capabilities have improved. The Facemoji keyboard can now predict emoji combinations based on what you type, and even directly look up relevant GIFs for you from a phrase you type in!

Blog Compass



Google's Blog Compass is a tool meant to help bloggers grow their online blogs. It suggests topics based on trends and your interests, along with providing traffic stats in a more user friendly format than Google Analytics.